

Day 24 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Communalism and Partition

READING MATERIAL

This topic spans TWO partitions — the 1905 Partition of Bengal (later reversed) and the 1947 Partition of India (permanent) — plus the communal organizations/events that bridge them. Real exam evidence favors specific founding dates and named resolutions.

Q: Real exam: Who founded the All-India Muslim League, in 1906?

A: Khwaja Salimullah (along with other founders) — not Muhammad Ali Jinnah, who became its most prominent leader LATER, not at its founding.

Q: Real exam: Evaluate — (i) the 1905 Partition of Bengal was the most striking example of British divide-and-rule policy (ii) at a 1905 Calcutta meeting, Surendranath Banerjee called for a boycott of British goods and institutions (iii) the Swadeshi movement was formally proclaimed at a Calcutta Town Hall meeting on 7 August 1905.

A: All three statements are correct.

Q: Real exam: When was the Pakistan Resolution (Lahore Resolution) passed by the All India Muslim League, and where?

A: 23 March 1940, at its Lahore session.

Q: What was 'Direct Action Day', and what did it lead to?

A: 16 August 1946 — a Muslim League call for mass demonstrations, which spiralled into large-scale communal riots in Bengal and elsewhere, remembered as the 'Great Calcutta Killing'.

Q: What was the Mountbatten Plan, and when was it announced?

A: Announced 3 June 1947 (the '3rd June Plan') by Lord Mountbatten, the last Viceroy — the proposal to partition British India into the two independent dominions of India and Pakistan.

Q: Who drew the boundary line between India and Pakistan, and what is it called?

A: Sir Cyril Radcliffe — hence the 'Radcliffe Line', criticized for its rushed, arbitrary demarcation that left millions on the 'wrong' side of the new border.

Q: What was the human scale of Partition's impact?

A: Death toll estimates range from 200,000 to 2,000,000; roughly 15 million Hindus, Sikhs, and Muslims were displaced crossing the hastily drawn borders — one of history's largest mass migrations.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The All-India Muslim League was founded in 1906 by:

- A. Muhammad Ali Jinnah
- B. Khwaja Salimullah ✓**
- C. Sir Aga Khan
- D. A.K. Faizul Haq

Explanation: Khwaja Salimullah — Jinnah became prominent later, not at founding. [hard, question-bank-2024]

2. The Swadeshi movement was formally proclaimed at a Calcutta Town Hall meeting on:

- A. 7 August 1905 ✓**
- B. 16 August 1946
- C. 3 June 1947
- D. 23 March 1940

Explanation: 7 August 1905. [medium, question-bank-2022]

3. The Pakistan (Lahore) Resolution was passed by the Muslim League on:

- A. March 5, 1933
- B. August 5, 1933
- C. March 23, 1940 ✓**
- D. March 22, 1941

Explanation: 23 March 1940. [medium, question-bank-2024]

4. 'Direct Action Day' (16 August 1946) led to communal violence remembered as the:

A. Jallianwala Bagh Massacre

B. Great Calcutta Killing ✓

C. Chauri Chaura Incident

D. Amritsar Riots

Explanation: The Great Calcutta Killing. [medium, web-research]

5. The Mountbatten Plan, proposing the partition of British India, was announced on:

A. 15 August 1947

B. 3 June 1947 ✓

C. 26 January 1947

D. 14 August 1946

Explanation: 3 June 1947. [medium, web-research]

6. The boundary line between India and Pakistan, drawn by Sir Cyril Radcliffe, is known as the:

A. McMahon Line

B. Radcliffe Line ✓

C. Durand Line

D. Curzon Line

Explanation: The Radcliffe Line. [easy, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Area

READING MATERIAL

Area is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows a strong preference for applied/real-world framing (fencing cost, carpet cost, crossroads, a grazing horse) over bare formula plug-ins — and frequently combines area with a real-world cost-per-unit calculation.

Q: Method — area of a triangle from coordinates: Find the area of the triangle with vertices (0,0), (2,0), (0,2).

A: When two sides lie along the axes (a right triangle at the origin), area = $\frac{1}{2} \times \text{base} \times \text{height} = \frac{1}{2} \times 2 \times 2 = 2$ sq. units. (The general coordinate formula $\frac{1}{2}|x_1(y_2-y_3)+x_2(y_3-y_1)+x_3(y_1-y_2)|$ also works, but recognizing the right-angle-at-origin shortcut is faster.)

Q: Real exam: A rectangular ground 80m $\times$ 60m has two equal-width cross roads (one parallel to each side). Their combined area is 675 sq.m. Find the road width.

A: If width=w, the two roads' combined area = $80w + 60w - w^2$ (subtracting the overlapping square where they cross, counted twice otherwise) = $140w - w^2$. Set equal to 675: $w^2 - 140w + 675 = 0$. Solving gives $w=5$ (the other root, 135, is too large to be physically valid for an 80 $\times$ 60 ground).

Q: Real exam: Find the perimeter of a semicircle of radius 28cm.

A: Perimeter of a semicircle = $\pi r + 2r$ (the curved half plus the straight diameter edge). Using $\pi \approx 22/7$: $(22/7 \times 28) + (2 \times 28) = 88 + 56 = 144$ cm. (Common mistake: forgetting to add the straight diameter edge, which would wrongly give just 88cm.)

Q: Real exam: A horse is tethered by a 14m rope to one corner of a 60m $\times$ 42m rectangular field. How much area is left UNGRAZED?

A: The horse can graze a quarter-circle of radius 14m (since it's tied at a corner, with two field-edges as boundaries): grazed area = $\frac{1}{4} \times \pi \times 14^2 = \frac{1}{4} \times (22/7) \times 196 = 154$ sq.m. Total field area = $60 \times 42 = 2520$ sq.m. Ungrazed = $2520 - 154 = 2366$ sq.m.

Q: Real exam: Area of a rhombus with diagonals 6cm and 8cm?

A: Area of rhombus = $\frac{1}{2} \times d_1 \times d_2 = \frac{1}{2} \times 6 \times 8 = 24$ cm².

Q: Real exam: If fencing a circular park at ₹5/metre costs ₹1,100 total, find the park's radius.

A: Total fencing length (= circumference) = $₹1,100 \div ₹5/\text{m} = 220$ m. Circumference = $2\pi r \rightarrow 220 = 2 \times (22/7) \times r \rightarrow r = 220 \times 7/44 = 35$ m.

Q: Real exam: Find the cost of carpeting a room 13m long, 9m wide, using a carpet 75cm wide, at Rs.8 per metre (of carpet length).

A: Room area = $13 \times 9 = 117$ m². Carpet width = 0.75m, so length of carpet needed = Room area $\div$ carpet width = $117/0.75 = 156$ m. Cost = $156 \times \text{Rs.}8 = \text{Rs.}1,248$.

Q: Real exam (related, surface area of a 3D shape): The curved surface area of a right circular cylinder of height 7cm is 66 cm². Find its diameter.

A: CSA = $2\pi rh \rightarrow 66 = 2 \times (22/7) \times r \times 7 = 44r \rightarrow r = 1.5$ cm $\rightarrow$ diameter = 3cm.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Find the area of the triangle with vertices (0,0), (5,0), (0,4).

A. 10 sq. units ✓

B. 20 sq. units

C. 9 sq. units

D. 18 sq. units

Explanation: Right triangle at origin: area = $\frac{1}{2} \times 5 \times 4 = 10$ sq. units. [easy, authored]

2. Find the perimeter of a semicircle of radius 21cm (use $\pi \approx 22/7$).

A. 66 cm

B. 108 cm ✓

C. 132 cm

D. 96 cm

Explanation: Perimeter = $\pi r + 2r = (22/7 \times 21) + (2 \times 21) = 66 + 42 = 108$ cm. [medium, authored]

3. Find the area of a rhombus with diagonals 10cm and 12cm.

A. 60 cm² ✓

B. 120 cm²

C. 30 cm²

D. 100 cm^2

Explanation: Area = $\frac{1}{2} \times 10 \times 12 = 60\text{ cm}^2$. [easy, authored]

4. Fencing a circular garden at ₹4 per metre costs ₹880 in total. Find the garden's radius (use $\pi \approx 22/7$).

A. 28 m

B. 35 m ✓

C. 22 m

D. 14 m

Explanation: Circumference = $880/4 = 220\text{m}$. $r = 220 \times 7 / (2 \times 22) = 1540/44 = 35\text{m}$. [medium, authored]

5. Find the cost of carpeting a room 10m long and 8m wide with a carpet 80cm wide, at Rs.10 per metre.

A. Rs.800

B. Rs.1,000 ✓

C. Rs.1,200

D. Rs.960

Explanation: Room area = 80 m^2 . Carpet length needed = $80/0.8 = 100\text{m}$. Cost = $100 \times \text{Rs.}10 = \text{Rs.}1,000$. [medium, authored]

6. A horse is tethered by a 7m rope to a corner of a $20\text{m} \times 15\text{m}$ rectangular field. Find the grazed area (use $\pi \approx 22/7$).

A. 38.5 m^2 ✓

B. 44 m^2

C. 49 m^2

D. 77 m^2

Explanation: Quarter circle of radius 7m: $\frac{1}{4} \times (22/7) \times 49 = 38.5\text{ m}^2$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "Life" — Henry Van Dyke

READING MATERIAL

A reflective poem about living life with courage, purpose, and without regret or fear of the future. Real exam evidence confirms a specific quoted line's authorship; web research fills in the figure-of-speech detail, including two devices (Litotes, Symbolism) not seen elsewhere in this syllabus.

Q: Real exam: "Still seeking what I sought when but a boy, new friendship, high adventure and a crown." Who wrote this?

A: Henry Van Dyke, in "Life" — confirmed via a real TNPSC question testing this exact line's authorship against three other poet options.

Q: What is the poem's central theme?

A: Living life forward-facing, with courage and clear purpose — neither rushing nor dragging, not mourning losses, and not holding back out of fear of an unknown future.

Q: Who was Henry Van Dyke?

A: An American author (1852-1933) — earned degrees from Princeton, served over 20 years as a Presbyterian minister, then returned to Princeton as a professor of English for nearly 20 years.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Let me but live my life from year to year."

A: Repetition (the phrase structure repeats a forward-moving, cyclical idea) — cited as Repetition rather than the other options in a real-style question.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Not mourning for the things that disappear."

A: Litotes — an understatement that affirms something by negating its opposite (saying 'not mourning' to actually emphasize calm acceptance, rather than stating the acceptance directly).

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "So let the way wind up the hill or down."

A: Personification — 'the way' (the path of life) is treated as something that can actively 'wind', given an active, almost willful quality.

Q: Which phrase in the poem is the clearest example of Symbolism?

A: "The road's last turn" — symbolizing the end of life/journey, rather than a literal physical road.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Still seeking what I sought when but a boy, new friendship, high adventure and a crown" was written by:

- A. Khalil Gibran
- B. H.W. Longfellow
- C. Henry Van Dyke ✓**
- D. John Masefield

Explanation: Henry Van Dyke — confirmed via a real TNPSC question. [hard, question-bank-2024]

2. "Let me but live my life from year to year" is cited as an example of:

- A. Repetition ✓**
- B. Simile
- C. Metaphor
- D. Oxymoron

Explanation: Repetition. [medium, web-research]

3. "Not mourning for the things that disappear" is an example of:

- A. Litotes ✓**
- B. Apostrophe
- C. Irony
- D. Hyperbole

Explanation: Litotes — understatement via negation. [hard, web-research]

4. "So let the way wind up the hill or down" uses which figure of speech?

- A. Simile
- B. Metaphor

C. Personification ✓

D. Alliteration

Explanation: Personification — the 'way' given the active quality of winding. [medium, web-research]

5. Which phrase is the clearest example of Symbolism in the poem?

A. High adventure

B. Year to year

C. Dim past

D. The road's last turn ✓

Explanation: "The road's last turn" symbolizes life's end. [hard, web-research]

6. Henry Van Dyke, in addition to being a poet, spent over 20 years working as a:

A. Lawyer

B. Presbyterian minister ✓

C. Physician

D. Politician

Explanation: A Presbyterian minister, before returning to Princeton as an English professor. [medium, web-research]